Website Copy — Version B Voice

Community Exchange · All Pages · 6th Grade Reading Level · March 2026

Voice: direct, honest, short sentences, no jargon. Meets people where they are. Never above them.

HOME / Homepage

HOOK

Most people never show up. Not because they don't care. Because nobody showed them the way in.

HEADLINE

This is the way in.

SUBHEAD

Houston has everything — the organizations, the officials, the resources, the people doing the work. We made it findable.

SEARCH PLACEHOLDER

What do you care about?

QUICK LINKS

Find my way in · In my neighborhood · What's happening now

CARDS

Chart Your Course — Choose your own adventure.
Library — Read. Learn. Go deeper.
News — What's happening in Houston.

HIGH /call-your-senators Call Your Senators

HOOK

Most people think their voice doesn't matter. Most people are wrong.

HEADLINE

Call your senators. It works.

SUBHEAD

Two minutes. One call. Your senators have staff whose only job is to count opinions like yours.

INTRO

You don't need a speech. You don't need to be an expert. You just need to say what you think and where you live.

That's it. That's the whole thing.

HOW IT WORKS

Pick an issue. Housing. Schools. Healthcare. Pick one thing.
We find your senators. Both of them, based on your state.
We give you a script. Short. Clear. In plain English.
You call. Two minutes. Done.

CTA

Find My Senators

CLOSING

Democracy doesn't run on autopilot. It runs on people like you picking up the phone.

HIGH

/foundations

Foundations

HOOK

Billions of dollars are invested in Houston every year. Most residents have no idea.

HEADLINE

The foundations funding Houston — all in one place.

SUBHEAD

They fund the work. We make it findable.

INTRO

Houston has one of the most generous philanthropic communities in the country. Health. Education. Housing. Arts. Civic life. There are hundreds of foundations working on all of it.

Most people never know they exist.

This page changes that.

WHAT YOU CAN DO

Find foundations working on what you care about. Browse by issue area.
See who they fund. Connect the dots between money and mission.
Understand the landscape. Whether you're a nonprofit, a researcher, or just curious — start here.

CTA

Explore Houston Foundations

MED

/knowledge-graph

Knowledge Graph

HOOK

Everything in Houston civic life is connected. Nobody was showing you how.

HEADLINE

The Civic Knowledge Galaxy.

SUBHEAD

Not a list. Not a directory. A living map of how it all fits together.

INTRO

A city council vote affects a neighborhood. A nonprofit serves families in that neighborhood. A foundation funds the nonprofit. A state law shapes what the foundation can do.

Those connections are real. Until now, nobody was showing them to you.

We built a knowledge graph — 174 tables, 16 types of entities, updated every day — that maps all of it.

WHAT'S CONNECTED

Officials — Every elected representative at every level of government.
Services — Real help for real needs. Housing, food, legal, health.
Organizations — Houston's nonprofit and civic community.
Policies — Legislation tracked from introduction to law.
Opportunities — Ways to show up and get involved.
News — Civic content in plain language, classified so you can find it.

THE POINT

Most platforms show you one thing. We show you how everything connects. That's the difference between a list and a map.

MED

/goodthings

Three Good Things

HOOK

The news can make you feel like everything is broken. It isn't.

HEADLINE

Three good things. Every day.

SUBHEAD

Real stories. Local. Updated daily. Because the news isn't only bad.

INTRO

Every day in Houston, people are showing up. Nonprofits are solving hard problems. Neighbors are helping neighbors. Civic leaders are fighting for something.

Three Good Things is three of those stories — every day.

We're not ignoring the hard stuff. We're making sure the good stuff gets seen too.

WHY IT MATTERS

When people believe good things are possible, they're more likely to do something. Hope isn't soft. It's fuel.

CTA

See Today's Three Good Things

MED

/dashboard-live

Live Dashboard

HOOK

You can't shape what you can't see.

HEADLINE

Houston civic life — right now.

SUBHEAD

Real data. Updated every morning. No spin.

INTRO

Not a snapshot from last year. Not a press release. Live data from the sources that matter — city, county, state, and federal — updated before you wake up.

City Council votes. County decisions. State bills moving through committees. Federal dollars coming into Houston.

All of it. Plain language. One place.

WHAT YOU'RE LOOKING AT

Legislative activity — What's moving, what passed, what failed.
Civic organizations — Who's active and what they're working on.
Community resources — Services available right now, by neighborhood.
Ways to show up — Meetings, hearings, volunteer shifts, events.

NOTE

Data syncs every morning between 7 and 10 AM Central. Check back after 10 if something looks off.

LOW

/search

Search

PERSISTENT INTRO

Search everything — officials, services, organizations, news, policies, opportunities. Use the tabs to narrow it down, or search across all of it at once.

PLACEHOLDER

What are you looking for?

EMPTY STATE

Nothing yet. Try a neighborhood name, an issue, or a person.

NO RESULTS

We didn't find that. Try fewer words, or search something nearby.

MED

/polling-places

Polling Places

HOOK

Voting is the one thing nobody can do for you.

HEADLINE

Find where to vote. Thirty seconds.

SUBHEAD

Early voting. Election Day. Mail ballots. It's all here.

INTRO

Enter your address. Get your polling place, your hours, and everything you need to show up ready.

No excuses. No surprises.

I18N STRINGS TO VERIFY (EN / ES / VI)

find_polling_place — "Find your polling place"
enter_address — "Enter your address"
early_voting — "Early voting locations"
election_day — "Election Day location"
hours — "Hours"
bring_id — "What to bring"
mail_ballot — "Request a mail ballot"

CTA

Find My Polling Place

LOW

/me/settings

Settings

HEADER

Your settings.

ONE-LINER

Language, notifications, saved items, and account info — all in one place.

SECTION LABELS

Language — English, Spanish, or Vietnamese. Switch any time.
Notifications — Tell us what to keep you updated on.
Saved — Everything you've bookmarked.
Account — Update your email or password.

LOW

/login

Login

HEADLINE

Good to have you back.

SUBHEAD

Sign in to pick up where you left off.

NO ACCOUNT

Don't have an account? You don't need one to look around. But if you want to save things and get updates — it's free.

FORGOT PASSWORD

Forgot your password? No stress — we'll sort it.

LOW

/reset-password

Reset Password

HEADLINE

Let's get you back in.

SUBHEAD

Enter your email. We'll send you a link. Check your spam if it doesn't show up in a few minutes.

SUCCESS

Check your inbox. The link expires in 24 hours.

CTA

Send Reset Link

HIGH

/manual

User Manual

HOOK

You don't need a guide to use this. But here's one anyway.

HEADLINE

How Community Exchange works.

SUBHEAD

Start anywhere. The platform will show you what connects.

START WITH YOUR ADDRESS

The fastest way in is your address. Type it into Civic Compass and we'll show you every elected official who represents you — city council, county commissioner, state rep, state senator, U.S. representative, U.S. senator.

All of them. One place. Right now.

BROWSE BY WHAT MATTERS TO YOU

Not sure where to start? Pick a pathway. Seven themes — housing, health, education, environment, economy, safety, civic life. Pick the one that's closest to what you care about.

Inside each pathway: organizations working on it, services available for it, news about it, officials responsible for it.

SEARCH FOR ANYTHING

Use the search bar. A name, a place, an issue, an organization. Use the tabs to filter by type. Everything updates daily.

FOLLOW WHAT'S HAPPENING

The live dashboard shows what's moving right now — legislation, community activity, events you can attend.

Three Good Things shows you three positive civic stories every day.

SAVE WHAT MATTERS

Create a free account to save officials, organizations, and articles. Set your language. Get notified about things in your area.

You don't need an account. But it helps if you want to keep track.

LANGUAGES

English, Spanish, and Vietnamese. Switch in the top navigation or in your settings.

All service content is reviewed by a human editor before it publishes in any language.

WAYFINDER

At the bottom of every page — every official, every organization, every service — you'll see Wayfinder. It shows you what's connected to what you're looking at. Three hops out from any starting point.

It's how you go from 'I need help with rent' to 'here are the organizations, the officials responsible, and the policy that funds it' — without having to already know where to look.

CLOSING

That's it. Start with what you know. The platform shows you the rest.

Questions? Reach us at hello@changeengine.us.

HIGH

/donate

Donate

HOOK

Civic infrastructure shouldn't cost money to access. Building it does.

HEADLINE

Help us keep it free for everyone.

SUBHEAD

Community Exchange is free. It stays free because people like you think it should be.

MISSION

Knowing who represents you. Finding services in your neighborhood. Understanding how to get involved. That information shouldn't cost anything to access.

But building and maintaining the platform that makes it all findable — that costs real money.

Your donation keeps the data accurate, the platform running, and the doors open.

WHAT YOUR MONEY DOES

174 tables of connected civic data — updated every day.
4 levels of government synced every morning.
3 languages — English, Spanish, Vietnamese.
6th-grade reading level on every piece of content.

Zero ads. Ever.

TIERS

$10/month — Neighbor. Keeps one data source synced for a month.
$25/month — Block Captain. Covers translation costs for one language.
$50/month — Connector. Supports one week of editorial review.
$100/month — Infrastructure Partner. Covers hosting and database for a month.
Your amount. Give what you can. All of it matters.

TAX INFO

The Change Lab is fiscally sponsored by Impact Hub Houston, a 501(c)(3). Your donation is tax-deductible.

CTA

Make a Donation

CLOSING

Civic infrastructure only works if someone maintains it. Thank you for being that someone.

LOW

/districts

Districts

HOOK

You live in more districts than you think.

HEADLINE

Every district. Every representative. Mapped.

SUBHEAD

City council. County precinct. State house and senate. Congress. They all overlap where you live.

INTRO

Enter your address. See every political boundary that covers your block — and every person responsible for what happens inside it.

COMING SOON NOTE

Full district mapping launches with Geographic Phase 2.

CTA

Enter Your Address

LOW

/quizzes

Civic Quizzes

HOOK

You know more than you think. Let's find out.

HEADLINE

How well do you know your city?

SUBHEAD

Short quizzes. Free. Actually interesting.

INTRO

Civic engagement starts with civic knowledge. And the best way to learn is to test yourself.

Pick a quiz. Take five minutes. Walk away knowing something you didn't before.

QUIZ TYPES

Know Your Government — Who does what at city, county, state, and federal levels.
Houston History — The people, places, and moments that shaped this city.
Voting & Elections — Your rights, the process, and how it all works.
Civic Superpower — What kind of civic person are you? Find out.

CTA

Take a Quiz

MED

/guide

Guide — Magazine

HOOK

What's happening in Houston civic life. Written so anyone can understand it.

HEADLINE

Your guide to what's going on.

SUBHEAD

Curated. Local. Updated daily.

INTRO

News. Analysis. Community stories. Explainers about how Houston works.

Every piece is reviewed by a human editor, rewritten at a sixth-grade reading level, and organized so you can find what matters to you.

Pick your perspective below.

MED

/compass

Civic Compass

HOOK

Most people don't know who represents them. That's not their fault. It's a design problem. We fixed it.

INTRO (VERIFY RENDERS IN CLIENT COMPONENT)

Type in your Houston address. We'll show you every elected official who represents you — from City Council to Congress — with their contact info, committees, and recent activity.

No account needed. No fine print. Just your address.

PLACEHOLDER

Enter your address — street, city, zip

EMPTY STATE

Enter your address above to find your representatives.

ERROR STATE

We couldn't find that address. Try adding your zip code.

ALL /footer

Footer

TAGLINE

Community life, organized.

ABOUT BLURB

Community Exchange is a community discovery platform built by The Change Lab in Houston. We connect residents to the officials, services, organizations, and opportunities that already exist — in their language, at their level, in their neighborhood.

COLUMN 1 — DISCOVER

Civic Compass · Pathways · Guide · Live Dashboard · Three Good Things · Polling Places

COLUMN 2 — LEARN

Knowledge Graph · Quizzes · User Manual · Districts · Foundations

COLUMN 3 — ACT

Call Your Senators · Volunteer · Donate · Partner With Us

COLUMN 4 — ABOUT

About The Change Lab · Our Approach · Contact · Accessibility · Privacy Policy

BOTTOM BAR

© 2026 The Change Lab. Fiscally sponsored by Impact Hub Houston, a 501(c)(3).
Built in Houston. For Houston.
English · Español · Tiếng Việt

MISSION LINE

> We didn't build anything new. We just made what already exists findable.